

FOOD SAFETY

Teens (14–18)

Q

What pH level separates high-acid foods from low-acid foods in home food preservation?

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ANSWER

pH 4.6

FUN FACT

Pathogenic bacteria can't grow well in foods with a pH of 4.6 or below!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Why is it unsafe to store low-acid foods at room temperature in oil for preservation?

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ANSWER

Because low-acid foods in oxygen-free oil can allow deadly *Clostridium botulinum* to grow.

FUN FACT

Bacteria that cause botulism need no oxygen and low acidity to grow, which oil can create.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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What is the safe minimum internal temperature to which eggs should be cooked to avoid Salmonella?

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ANSWER

160°F (when whites and yolks are firm)

FUN FACT

Cooking eggs to 160°F makes them safe to eat by killing Salmonella bacteria.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Why does heat preservation (like canning) stop enzymatic action in foods?

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ANSWER

Heating destroys enzymes that cause unwanted color and flavor changes.

FUN FACT

Enzymes cause fruits and veggies to ripen and spoil, so heat stops that process.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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What temperature range is called the 'danger zone' for bacterial growth in food?

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ANSWER

40°F to 140°F

FUN FACT

Bacteria grow fastest between 60°F and 125°F, so keep food cold or really hot!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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What is the main risk when home canning low-acid foods without using a pressure canner?

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ANSWER

Clostridium botulinum bacteria can survive and produce deadly toxin.

FUN FACT

Botulism toxin is deadly but invisible - safe canning heat kills the bacteria first.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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How should cooked egg dishes be handled to keep them safe after cooking?

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ANSWER

Serve immediately or refrigerate within 2 hours and use within 3-4 days.

FUN FACT

Bacteria can grow fast, so refrigerate cooked eggs quickly to stay safe.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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What cleaning practice helps prevent cross-contamination after handling raw poultry or meat?

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ANSWER

Wash all utensils, cutting boards, and surfaces with hot soapy water immediately.

FUN FACT

Cleaning with hot soapy water kills germs that spread from raw meat to other foods.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Why is acidity important for food safety in home preservation?

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ANSWER

Because acid ($\text{pH} \leq 4.6$) stops harmful bacteria like *Clostridium botulinum* from growing.

FUN FACT

Pickles and most fruits are high-acid, so they are safer to can with boiling water baths.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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What is a key reason that freezing preserves food safely?

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ANSWER

Freezing stops bacterial growth by slowing down enzymes and microbes.

FUN FACT

Freezing puts microbes to sleep but doesn't always kill them, so handle leftovers carefully.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Which food type is more perishable and a bigger safety concern: cooked or uncooked food?

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ANSWER

Cooked food

FUN FACT

Cooking makes food softer and easier for bacteria to grow if it's not handled properly.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Why should eggs be stored below 40°F and not at room temperature?

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ANSWER

To slow bacterial growth like Salmonella and keep eggs safe to eat.

FUN FACT

Cold storage slows harmful bacteria and keeps eggs fresh longer.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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What does heating food to the recommended temperature in home canning or cooking do?

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ANSWER

Destroys harmful bacteria and enzymes that cause spoilage and illness.

FUN FACT

Heat is your food's best defense against dangerous bacteria and spoilage.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Q

If a recipe calls for raw eggs in the final product, what is a safe preparation method?

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ANSWER

Use pasteurized eggs or heat eggs to 160°F while stirring before use.

FUN FACT

Pasteurized eggs have been gently heated to kill bacteria but keep their fresh taste.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Q

What is a recommended way to store freshly made garlic or herb oils safely at home?

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ANSWER

Keep refrigerated and use within 4 days or freeze for long-term storage.

FUN FACT

Fresh herbs in oil can grow botulism bacteria if not refrigerated promptly.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Why should perishable foods be refrigerated in shallow containers soon after preparation?

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ANSWER

So they cool quickly and reduce the time food spends in the danger zone.

FUN FACT

Quick cooling slows bacterial growth, keeping your leftovers safer to eat.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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What is a sign that cooked food may have been improperly handled or spoiled?

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ANSWER

**Unusual smell, slimy texture,
or visible mold on the food.**

FUN FACT

Sometimes spoiled food looks and smells bad; other times it may be risky without signs.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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What does blanching vegetables before freezing do for food preservation?

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ANSWER

Slows enzyme action that causes color and flavor changes during storage.

FUN FACT

Blanching is a quick heat process that helps veggies keep their bright color and flavor.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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How often should you collect eggs from your chickens to reduce contamination risk?

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ANSWER

Frequently, preferably daily.

FUN FACT

Frequently collecting eggs prevents dirt and bacteria buildup on shells.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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What does safe home food preservation target to prevent deterioration?

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ANSWER

Stopping or slowing the growth of microorganisms and enzyme activity.

FUN FACT

Preservation keeps food tasty and safe by controlling microbial growth and enzyme changes.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics